CHUNGMANN KIM

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Research Interests

Development economics · humanitarian finance · food-security measurement · child nutrition · applied econometrics · spatial econometrics · AI for humanitarian research

Current Academic Position

- **Bloomberg School of Public Health, Johns Hopkins University** *Jan 2026 – Present*
  Postdoctoral Research Fellow, ***Center for Humanitarian Health*** *(full-time)* Baltimore, MD
  - **Climate, conflict and displacement (Iraq):** Spatial models of climate, conflict, displacement and refugee movements
  - **Humanitarian funding (13 crisis countries):** Subnational allocation of humanitarian aid relative to needs and displacement

Education

- **University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign** *2025*
  Ph.D. in Applied Economics (Agricultural and Consumer Economics); advisor: Kathy Baylis United States
- **Seoul National University** *2019*
  M.Sc. in Agricultural Technology Republic of Korea
- **Handong Global University** *2015*
  B.Sc. in Environmental Studies, cum laude Republic of Korea

Publications (Peer-Reviewed)

"**Official Estimates of Global Food Insecurity Undercount Acute Hunger**." Lentz, E., Baylis, K., Michelson, H., & **Kim, C.** (2025). *Nature Food* 6(12): 1196–1208. [LINK] | [Replication Code]
AAEA Quality of Research Discovery Award (2025)

"**Inside the Black Box: How Consistent Are Global Food Security Crisis Analyses?**" Lentz, E., Baylis, K., Michelson, H., & **Kim, C.** (2026). *Food Policy* 138: 103028. [LINK] | [Replication Code]

"**Machine Learning for Food Security: Principles for Transparency and Usability**." Zhou, Y., Lentz, E., Michelson, H., **Kim, C.**, & Baylis, K. (2022). *Applied Economic Perspectives and Policy* 44(2): 893–910. [LINK]

"**Exploring the Association between Agricultural Production Systems and Household Diets in Viet Nam**." Bandyopadhyay, A., Azzarri, C., Haile, B., **Kim, C.**, et al. (2022). *Food Security* 14(5): 1207–1226. [LINK]

"**The Economics of the Soy Kit for Food Entrepreneurs**." **Kim, C.** & Goldsmith, P. (2021). *Food and Nutrition Bulletin*. [LINK]

"**Vietnamese Preferences for Fresh Korean Ginseng**." Joo, Y., Kim, T., Nguyen, D.K., & **Kim, C.** (2021). *Korean Journal of Agricultural Economics*. [LINK]

Working Papers

"**Hearing the Alarm: Do Donors Follow Institutional Crisis Signals?**" (job market paper) [Draft]
Builds a geocoded, purpose-labelled aid-flow dataset from OCHA Financial Tracking Service records and uses staggered difference-in-differences around IPC Phase 4 escalations in Afghanistan; finds a positive but delayed aid response.
Presented: UNU-WIDER Development Conference 2025 (full travel grant) · EAAE 2025 · AAEA 2025 (poster) · APHA 2026 (oral)

"**Early-Year Milk Price and Child Stunting in Zambia**." [Draft | Slides]
Links the Zambia DHS to historical milk prices; higher prices at 12–24 months of age are associated with higher stunting risk among children aged 24–59 months.
Presented: AAEA 2022 · EAAE 2023 · Tata-Cornell 2023 · APHA 2026 (poster)

"**Multidimensional Food Security Indicators: Evidence from Sub-Saharan Africa**." With Baylis, K., Lentz, E., & Michelson, H.
Tests whether FCS, rCSI and asset indicators measure the same construct across Malawi, Ethiopia and Nigeria and over four waves of the Malawi IHPS. AAEA 2022 track session.

Work in Progress

"**Conflict Areas, Displacement and Humanitarian Allocation Chains: Evidence from the Democratic Republic of the Congo**." PI, with Spiegel, P. & Altare, C. (CEPR ReCIPE grant proposal)

"**Climate Change, Conflict, Displacement and Health in Mali and Iraq**." With the Center for Humanitarian Health

"**H-Aid Tracker: AI-Powered Subnational Humanitarian Aid Mapping**." NLP/LLM geocoding of 333,087 OCHA FTS funding records (2000–2025) with human review

"**Acute Food Insecurity Data and Modelling**." With Ronco, M., Machefer, M., et al. (EC Joint Research Centre)

Policy Reports and Technical Work

Lentz, E., Baylis, K., Michelson, H., & **Kim, C.** "IPC Accuracy Study: Analyzing the Internal Consistency of IPC AFI and AMN Analyses." IPC report, 2024. [Report]

Kim, C., Alvarez, C., Sattar, A., Bandyopadhyay, A., Azzarri, C., Moltedo, A., & Haile, B. "Production, Consumption, and Food Security in Viet Nam: Diagnostic Overview." IFPRI, 2021. [Report]

Koo, J., & **Kim, C.** "Mapping of Poultry Hotspots in Tanzania." IFPRI Technical Note, 2018. [Note]

LACI framework (Learning, Assessing, Calibrating, Integrating) for reviewing AI, machine-learning and statistical outputs before use in IPC analysis, FAO IPC GSU with EC-JRC, 2025–2026. [LACI-Framework]

Professional Experience

- **FAO, IPC Global Support Unit** — *Feb 2024 – Present*
  Data Scientist and Modelling Specialist, consultant (part-time, 390 days) — Home-based, United States
  - Lead development of the LACI model-review framework; IPC focal point for the EC-JRC collaboration on model evaluation and food-insecurity forecasting
  - Developed and validated a prototype that extracts crisis signals from news (South Sudan); member, IPC ATARI Working Group
- **International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD)** — *Sep 2023 – Jan 2024*
  Impact Assessment Specialist, consultant (part-time, 50 days) — Home-based
  - Harmonized IFAD11/12 impact-assessment data across 10+ countries; contributed to a Nepal climate-adaptation evaluation
- **FAO, IPC Global Support Unit** — *Oct 2022 – Aug 2023*
  Food Security Analyst, consultant (part-time, 120 days) — Home-based, United States
  - Led the empirical analysis of the IPC Accuracy Study (more than 10,000 subnational analyses, 2017–2023)
- **International Food Policy Research Institute (IFPRI)** — *Oct 2018 – Jan 2019*
  Research Intern (full-time) — Washington, DC
- **Canaan Farmer School** — *Jan 2015 – Dec 2017*
  Project and Training Officer (2016–2017); Intern (2015) — Korea & Tanzania

Teaching

Teaching Assistant, University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign
ACE 251 The World Food Economy (Fall 2024; delivered weekly lectures) · ACE 435 Global Agribusiness Management (Fall 2022, Fall 2023; coordination and grading)
Teaching materials: Data Science for Policy Research (Python, machine learning, NLP, geospatial analysis, causal inference)

Teaching interests: development economics · food and agricultural economics · applied econometrics · data science for policy

Presentations and Invited Talks

APHA Annual Meeting (2026) · Cornell CIDER Thought Summit on Data Science for Humanitarian Response (2026; co-presented LACI) · Food Assistance Strategic Dialogue, Johns Hopkins (2026) · Stanford Center on Food Security and the Environment seminar (2025) · UNU-WIDER Development Conference (2025) · AAEA (2022, 2025) · EAAE (2023, 2025) · Tata-Cornell Institute Conference (2023)

Honors and Awards

AAEA Quality of Research Discovery Award (2025, *Nature Food* paper) · Top-5 finalist across Johns Hopkins schools, AI + Health Care Idea Tank (2026) · ACE Doctoral Fellowship, University of Illinois (2025) · Full travel grant, UNU-WIDER Development Conference (2025) · Travel grants, AAEA (2025) and ACE Department (2022, 2025) · Banaba House Scholarship (2022–2024) · Cum laude, Handong Global University (2015)

Service and Affiliations

Referee: *Nature Food*, *BMC Public Health* · Member, IPC Advanced Technologies and Artificial Intelligence (ATARI) Working Group · Vice President, ACE Graduate Student Organization, UIUC (2020–2021) · Member, AAEA and EAAE · Organized UNHCR relief fundraising with 100+ community members

Methods, Tools and Languages

Methods: staggered DiD and event studies · panel and spatial econometrics · IV, RD, matching · random forest, gradient boosting, LASSO · NLP and LLM pipelines · geospatial analysis
Tools: Python · R · Stata · SQL · Git · QGIS · Google Earth Engine
Languages: Korean (native) · English (fluent) · Chinese (intermediate)

References

Kathy Baylis
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